



Re: Sodium policy modeling study

From Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>

Date Tue 5/26/2026 3:09 PM

To Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>

Cc Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>; David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>

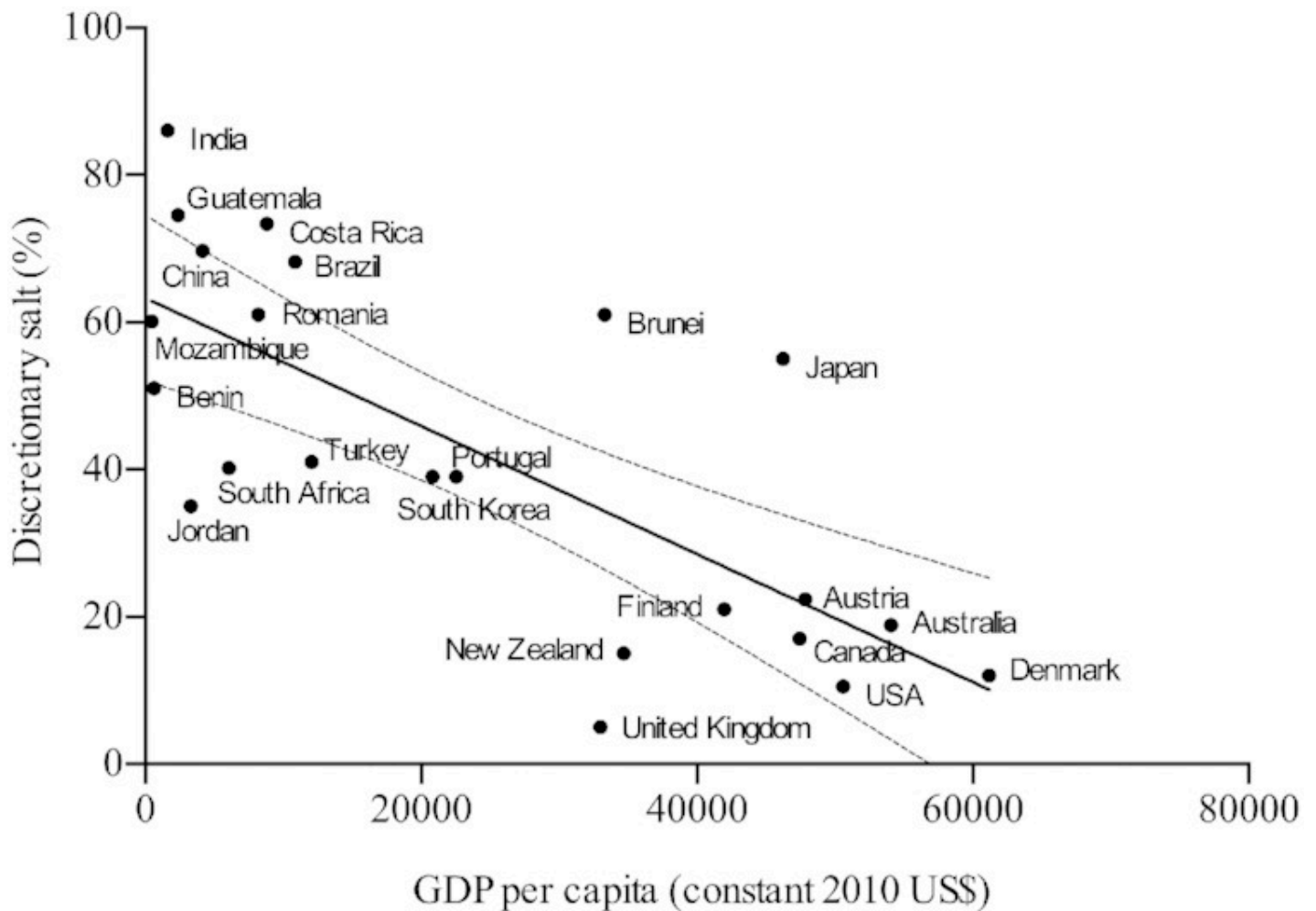
Hi Zina,

Yes, I am happy to share the details. For the global LSSS analysis, we used a rather simplistic approach, predicting the proportion of sodium from discretionary salt based on the GDP per capita. This was informed by our systematic review of sources of sodium (<https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2161831322002927>), where we fitted the proportion of sodium coming from discretionary salt as a function of per capita GDP. For the modelling study, we used the regression equation and GDP per capita data for each country and included floor and ceiling values to prevent any country to have 0% or 100% of all sodium from discretionary salt.

I can share more details when we meet on Thursday but let me know if you have any immediate questions.

Best,

Matti



From: Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>

Sent: Tuesday, May 26, 2026 3:10 PM

To: Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>

Cc: Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>; davidaw <davidaw@uw.edu>; Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>

Subject: Re: Sodium policy modeling study

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Hi Matti,

Hope you're doing well. Nicole and I have been digging into sources of sodium in the literature which has been quite difficult. For the purposes of our work, we're interested in the shares from packaged foods, discretionary sources, and public food procurement.

It would be great to hear how you broke down discretionary vs. packaged sources in your LSS study. If you're available, would you be open to briefly presenting on this during Thursday's UW modeling call at 4 pm ET?

Thanks so much,
Zina

Zina Abourjeily (She/Her) ([Hear my name](#))
Program Officer, Nutrition Policy
zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org



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From: Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>
Date: Thursday, May 21, 2026 at 2:32 PM
To: Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; davidaw <davidaw@uw.edu>
Cc: Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>
Subject: Re: Sodium policy modeling study

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Hi David, Laura, and David,

Yes, I am not too worried about the publication timeline. Our paper is with BMJ and we should soon hear back from them.

Our paper is also different from your approach. We used a comparative risk assessment framework to estimate the potential overall health impact, including likely reduction of blood pressure related diseases and possible additional hyperkalemia related deaths. We have used a similar approach for our country-specific analyses for China and India. It does not use your type of state-transitioning framework, which allows modelling over different time horizons. We also have not done direct comparisons with other sodium reduction policies.

However, I am happy to discuss if some of our data/assumptions could be helpful for your analyses (e.g. estimation of contribution of discretionary vs non-discretionary salt, or blood pressures effect of potassium and sodium).

Happy to discuss further.

Best regards,

Matti

From: Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>
Sent: Thursday, May 21, 2026 12:42:50 PM
To: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>; Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; davidaw <davidaw@uw.edu>
Cc: Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>
Subject: Re: Sodium policy modeling study

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Hi there

The main goal here isn't publication (which is nice) but having these estimates as part of our renewal process. It will still be jnoortant to have estimates in the not too distant future. Perhaps we can feed some of Matti's in somehow for internal estimates?

Laura

From: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Sent: Thursday, May 21, 2026 6:22:55 PM
To: Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>; mmarklu1 <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>
Cc: Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>
Subject: Re: Sodium policy modeling study

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Thanks, Laura. Understood. I saw the WHO guideline on LSS, which we will accommodate.

It will take us an extra 1-2 months to incorporate LSS into the model since there are additional data inputs we'll need beyond what is currently there.

[@Matti Marklund](#) we don't want to get in the way of your paper with this piece of work. I presume it's under review? How can we coordinate publication efforts so that yours is guaranteed to come out first?

From: Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>
Sent: Thursday, May 21, 2026 2:09 AM
To: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>; mmarklu1 <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>
Cc: Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>
Subject: RE: Sodium policy modeling study

Hi William,

Unfortunately I think leadership is very interested in the LSS modeling as well, so it is a key part of the work. This will inform our renewal application to Bloomberg so we need to be able to include it.

Also, you might notice that LSSS is included in the newest version of the SHAKE package that was released last week.

Best
Laura

From: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Sent: Thursday, May 21, 2026 2:47 AM
To: mmarklu1 <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>
Cc: Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; davidaw <davidaw@uw.edu>; Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>
Subject: Re: Sodium policy modeling study
Sensitivity: Private

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Hi Zina and Matti,

Thanks again for sharing the materials. The SharePoint link works well on my end, and I'll start reviewing and adding comments there.

On the LSS question, after discussing internally with David, we should keep the current paper focused on the interventions in the Word document that map to the broader SHAKE framework, and not explicitly incorporate the LSS intervention analysis at this stage. Given the overlap with other interventions, it makes sense to give Matti's team space to move the LSS work forward, and we can revisit potential integration later if needed.

Best,

William Garcia
PhD Candidate, Health Metrics & Implementation Science

University of Washington

From: Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>
Sent: Wednesday, May 20, 2026 6:44 AM
To: Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Cc: Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>
Subject: Re: Sodium policy modeling study

Hi Zina,

Thank you for sharing this material. I am attaching some of our previous sodium modelling studies on salt substitution and sodium targets. With my team at TGI, we have ongoing cost-effectiveness analyses on salt substitution (Australia, China, Nigeria, UK), sodium targets (Nigeria), and FOPL (Nigeria). I am happy to provide more details when we meet.

Our global analysis of the health impact of salt substitutes that you referred to is currently under review. I will meet with the project lead, Polly, tonight and ask her if she has any updates.

Thanks,

Matti

From: Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>
Sent: Tuesday, May 19, 2026 10:17 PM
To: wrgg <wrgg@uw.edu>
Cc: Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; davidaw <davidaw@uw.edu>; Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>; Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>
Subject: Re: Sodium policy modeling study

You don't often get email from zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org. [Learn why this is important](#)

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Hi William,

Thank you for your patience.

I've shared the document we've prepared for you too look through. I'm still working on compiling the sources of sodium into the document, and am aiming to wrap that up next week.

One question to flag is that we don't want to duplicate the [work that has recently \(almost\) been published](#) on lives saved from LSS, but we're not sure how we might incorporate the work from that paper. What do you think? I've notes that on the last page as an "outstanding question" which is a great place to track bigger picture discussions/questions.

I've shared the [SharePoint document](#) with you, and if that works, it would be great to make comments directly there. If that doesn't work, I've attached a copy to this email.

Very Best,
Zina

From: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>

Date: Friday, May 15, 2026 at 4:20 PM

To: Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>; David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>; Obehi Aimiosior <oaimiosior@resolvetosavelives.org>; Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>

Subject: Re: Sodium policy modeling study

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Hi All,

Just following up on the sodium policy timeline below. Zina/Laura/Nicole if you have any updates or preliminary inputs you could share by Monday, that would be very helpful so I can prepare the policy input table ahead of our discussion.

Thanks again, and looking forward to moving this forward.

Best,
William Garcia
PhD Candidate, Health Metrics & Implementation Science
University of Washington

From: Andrew Moran <amoran@resolvetosavelives.org>

Sent: Friday, April 24, 2026 8:20 AM

To: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>; Laura Cobb <lcobb@resolvetosavelives.org>; Obehi Aimiosior <oaimiosior@resolvetosavelives.org>; Matti Marklund <mmarklu1@jhu.edu>; Zina Abourjeily <zabourjeily@resolvetosavelives.org>; Nicole Ide <nide@resolvetosavelives.org>

Subject: Sodium policy modeling study

Hi All,

Yesterday I just had a brief discussion of timeline for the sodium policy analysis with David and William. See below what we propose, based on the discussion:

- **May 11:** Zina shares a preliminary table of sodium policies and effect sizes with William. William has a few days to get answers to his questions.
- **May 15:** William circulates the table of sodium policy inputs to the whole working group (Laura, Nicole, Zina, and Matti)
- **May 28:** (scheduled group call)—Whole group discusses sodium policy inputs; William presents the manuscript outline including shell tables, proposed figures; discussion of target journal/RTSL report; set deadlines for report and manuscript
- **Late June:** Meet to review tables and figures, assign writing tasks, pull in RTSL Comms/Design
- **End of June:** Report and paper are completed; paper submitted to journal

If everyone wants, I think we could move the 28 May call a week earlier

Let us know if we can agree to this timeline.

Thanks!

Andrew

From: amoran@resolvetosavelives.org
When: 4:00 PM - 5:00 PM April 23, 2026
Subject: RTSL UW CVH Modeling Research
Location: <https://resolvetosavelives.zoom.us/j/92449614866>

Andrew Moran is inviting you to a scheduled Zoom meeting.
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